CHAPTER 1

A Brave New World

In this chapter, we're going to make sure that you're set up with a working version of Docker on your machine. This is important so you can actually try it out for yourself and follow along with the examples.

Next, we'll dive straight in and execute our first ever Docker command—running a basic Ruby script. However, rather than relying on a version of Ruby installed on your local machine, we'll be using one supplied by Docker.

You'll learn the fundamentals of how Docker works, including what *images* and *containers* are and why we need them. We'll cover the basic anatomy of `docker run`—probably the most central command to understanding Docker.

We'll also begin our journey of incorporating Docker into our development workflow by learning how to generate a new Rails project with nothing but Docker. This app will become the subject of our various tinkering and discovery throughout the rest of the book.

Installing Docker

Let's get you set up with Docker on your machine.

There's little benefit to me walking you through the installation process step by step: Docker's docs do a great job at this and will stay more up to date. I'll simply point you in the right direction.

We're going to be using the free, Community Edition (CE),[1] rather than the Enterprise Edition (EE).[2] Docker CE itself comes in two flavors: *Edge*, which contains the latest features being developed, and *Stable*, which is, well, more

1. https://www.docker.com/community-edition
2. https://www.docker.com/enterprise-edition